

ANNOUNCEMENTS

1

China Passes the US in Clinical-Trial Starts, Reshaping Where AI-Era Drugs Get Developed

Source: *Every (newsletter); ITIF citing WHO ICTRP data · 2026-06-07*

China has overtaken the United States in the annual number of registered drug clinical trials for the first time. Using WHO registry data, ITIF reported China listed roughly 7,100 trials in a recent year against about 6,000 for the US.

2

Anthropic and the Gates Foundation Commit \$200 Million to Put AI Inside Global Health, Education, and Agriculture

Source: *Anthropic · 2026-05-25*

Anthropic and the Gates Foundation announced a four-year, \$200 million partnership. Largest share targets global health in low- and middle-income countries (polio, HPV, preeclampsia), vaccine/therapy development, education in sub-Saharan Africa and India, and agriculture for smallholder-farmer productivity.

3

Illinois Passes First State Law Requiring Independent Audits of Frontier AI Labs

Source: *Illinois House, via Transparency Coalition, Axios · 2026-05-30*

The Illinois House passed the AI Safety Measures Act by a vote of 110 to 0. If signed, it would be the first US law to mandate annual third-party audits of frontier AI labs, requiring independent safety audits, incident reporting,...

4

Anthropic Moves Claude Agents Inside the Customer Perimeter With Self-Hosted Sandboxes and Private MCP Tunnels

Source: *Anthropic, Code with Claude London · 2026-05-19*

At its London developer conference, Anthropic released self-hosted sandboxes in public beta and MCP tunnels in research preview. Self-hosted sandboxes let the tool-execution layer of an agent run on infrastructure controlled by the customer.

THE WEEK IN ONE LINE

The global clinical-trial map is redrawing toward China, AI is compressing discovery timelines into the trial phase, and the regulatory and security scaffolding around AI in life sciences is hardening — all of which amplifies the value of embedded clinical expertise at the center of the workflow.

Sources: Various AI/tech news outlets

WHAT IT MEANS

The center of gravity for early drug development is moving toward China, where trials run faster and cheaper and AI is compressing discovery timelines.

Like: *It is like manufacturing shifting overseas a generation ago: the lab bench, not just the factory floor, is now moving...*

Frontier AI capability is being deliberately pointed at vaccine and therapy development in LMIC settings. For an FSP whose embedded teams support sponsor clinical programs, this concentrates real capital behind...

Like: *Big philanthropic capital is doing for AI what the Gates Foundation did for vaccines twenty years ago: subsidizing the parts...*

For clinical-trial service providers, state-level AI audit mandates create a new vendor-due-diligence requirement that will flow into sponsor RFPs.

Like: *It is like the first state to require restaurants to post health-inspection grades in the window.*

For clinical-trial operations, the self-hosted sandbox directly addresses the data-governance barrier that keeps AI agents out of trial-data workflows.

Like: *It is the difference between letting a contractor take your files back to their office and letting them sit in...*

keel3.com

WHAT IT MEANS FOR: KPS LIFE

TRIAL STRATEGY

KPS's embedded clinical teams are increasingly likely to support sponsors whose trial portfolios span both US and China sites. The value KPS brings is not headcount — it is the embedded expertise that ensures data...

CLINICAL INNOVATION

The Gates-Anthropic partnership signals that AI in vaccine and therapy development is moving from pilot to program scale, and the therapeutic areas it targets — infectious disease, maternal health — overlap with trial work KPS's...

VENDOR ASSURANCE

KPS's embedded teams increasingly use or interact with AI-powered tools — for data review, safety signal detection, site feasibility analysis — that are supplied by third-party vendors.

CLINICAL OPERATIONS

KPS's embedded teams handle sensitive clinical data — patient records, safety reports, protocol documents — that have kept AI agent automation off the table for compliance reasons.

This brief is for informational purposes only and does not constitute legal, regulatory, or financial advice.